



STATUS REPORT

South Africa: status report

Edition of 2026-08-13 · 92 systems and instruments tracked, 11 of them not held

Compiled 2026-08-13 from the Data Landscapers source base, from [outputs/reports/ZAF/ledger.csv](#) (92 systems and instruments, 11 of them **Not held**). Each section opens with its ledger; specific events are covered in the monthly updates. Figures are dated because most are time-varying.

Status values. *Implemented* — in operation or in force. *Piloting* — running with a limited user group or in a controlled environment. *In development* — build or drafting under way, not yet operating. *Planned* — announced or provided for, no build or draft on record. *Enacted* — an instrument passed into law; pair with a qualifying clause for its in-force date. *Under review* — a law or policy currently being reconsidered. *Discontinued* — closed or superseded. *Not held* — the base carries no reliable statement of status; these are the gaps to fill and are listed again at the end.

Summary of position

South Africa runs a data-protection statute in force, a gazetted national frequency plan, a central bank that owns half of the instant payment rail, a reform programme publishing quarterly targets, and the African cloud regions of Google, Microsoft and Amazon. The payment rail and the frequency plan are publicly owned; the compute and storage most other systems depend on are largely private, and at hyperscale foreign. Most national-scale citizen-facing systems remain at pilot or pre-launch stage.

Operation Vulindlela's first-quarter report for 2026/27 states that reform progress "has been uneven and, in certain instances, slower than initially anticipated due to the complexity of institutional reforms" ([National Treasury and the Presidency, 2026-07-31](#)). A Public Service Commission investigation reported in July 2026 that the State Information Technology Agency carries [more than R2bn in irregular expenditure](#); separate reporting put procurement attrition at 25.2% and recorded [contracts outstanding beyond 400 days](#).

Infrastructure

Connectivity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Draft Radio Frequency Spectrum and Fees Regulations amendments	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Public hearings 2026-08-19/20
Equinix Cape Town land use	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Tribunal approval 2026-07-14
High-demand spectrum auction	PLANNED	No date; R51m appropriated

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
IMT Roadmap 2026 and draft assignment plans	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Consultation opened 2026-07-24
Innovation spectrum, lower 6GHz	IMPLEMENTED	Gazetted 2026-05-22
LEO satellite licensing framework	PLANNED ↗	Policy direction rejected 2026-05
National broadband map (DBSA)	IMPLEMENTED, NOT PUBLIC ↗	2026-03
National CSIRT (Cybersecurity Hub)	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Since 2015
National Cybersecurity Policy Framework	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Approved by Cabinet 2012-03
National GIS infrastructure database (rapid deployment reg. 7)	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Draft gazetted 2026-04
National Radio Frequency Plan 2026	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Gazetted 2026-07-24
SA Connect phase 2	DISCONTINUED ↗	Closed 2026-02
Satellite market entry via section 13	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Amazon Leo–Herotel, 2026-07-15
State Digital Infrastructure Company (network merger)	PLANNED ↗	Deferred to 2028/29
Data-centre incentive instrument (SEZ, depreciation, grid priority)	NOT HELD	Signalled 2026-02

Data Storage

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Teraco CT2, Cape Town	IMPLEMENTED ↗	+32MW to 50MW, 2025-11

Technical Capacity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
National Integrated Cyber Infrastructure System	IMPLEMENTED ↗	At maximum capacity, 2026-08-05

Legislation and regulation

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Electronic Communications Amendment Bill	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Submissions close 2026-08-21

Strategies, plans and policies

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Draft National Policy on Data and Cloud	PLANNED ↗	Draft of 2021, unresolved

Mapping for the Development Bank of Southern Africa puts fourth-generation coverage at 98% of the population, 12.2% of households more than 20km from a fibre node and over 6,700 of roughly 15,000 public schools between 10km and 25km from one; the [data is bank-owned and not published](#). SA Connect phase two [closed](#) having connected 6,343 government facilities and 32,055 community hotspots against a 2022 target of universal access, and [Broadband Infraco is reported as technically insolvent](#). The regulator [rejected the minister's equity-equivalence](#)

[policy direction](#) in May 2026, holding that a policy direction cannot override the Electronic Communications Act. [Draft amendments to the spectrum and fee regulations](#), on which oral hearings are set for 19-20 August 2026, would put satellite space-segment operators on a register.

The data-centre estate runs to over 50 facilities at roughly 350MW of combined critical load, [according to Teraco](#). Cape Town's planning tribunal [approved two Equinix facilities](#) on an application that did not disclose water or electricity demand. The Centre for High Performance Computing, one of three pillars of the National Integrated Cyber Infrastructure System, [has reached maximum capacity](#), Parliament's science committee reported after an oversight visit on 2026-08-05.

The national CSIRT is the Cybersecurity Hub, set up in 2015 under the National Cybersecurity Policy Framework Cabinet approved in March 2012; it [routes a reported incident to a sector CSIRT or to the police rather than resolving it](#), [operates 08:00-16:30 on weekdays and publishes no incident statistics or annual report](#). The only national cyber-security measurement held dates from 2024: [88% of organisations reported a breach in the preceding twelve months](#) (n=309), and [62% of cyber-security posts partially or fully unfilled](#).

Digital public infrastructure

Data Exchange

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
MzansiXchange data exchange	PILOTING ↗	Nine months in, 2026-07
SAHPRA VigiFlow serious-adverse-event e-reporting pilot	PILOTING ↗	Communication to industry CT02-2026/27, 2026-08-03
SARS-Malawi customs data exchange	PLANNED ↗	Arrangement signed 2026-08-05

Digital Identity and CRVS

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Digital driving licence	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Nearest dated milestone 2027-03
Draft Identification Regulations amendments	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Consultation closed 2026-06
Electronic travel authorisation	PILOTING ↗	National launch 2026-08-12
National digital identity (credential and wallet)	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Hosting due 2027-03-31

Digital Payments and Fintech

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Capitec-Walletdoc merger conditions	PLANNED, BEFORE THE COMPETITION TRIBUNAL ↗	Commission recommended approval 2026-08-06
CIPS participation (Standard Bank)	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Went live and inaugurated at the SARB 2025-11-20
Payments Ecosystem Modernisation credential and wallet	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Testing due 2026-11
Renminbi Clearing Bank of Africa	IMPLEMENTED ↗	PBoC authorisation announced 2026-06-26

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Retail central bank digital currency	PLANNED, NOT PROCEEDING ↗	"No compelling case", 2026-06
ZARU rand-backed stablecoin	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Listed on Luno Global 2026-08-07

Registries (population, land, address, etc.)

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Intelligent Population Register	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Announced 2026-06
National Population Register	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Operating; no current statement held

Sectoral management information systems (HMIS, EMIS, etc.)

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
National Digital Health Strategy 2019-2024	DISCONTINUED, TERM EXPIRED 2024 ↗	Term expired 2024; no successor held
NSFAS student funding system	IMPLEMENTED, UNDER ADMINISTRATION ↗	Stabilisation plan submitted 2026-08-07

Other GovTech and e-Gov

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Batho Pele AI chatbot	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Launched 2026-07-31
Digital matric certificate	PILOTING ↗	Integration due 2026-09
District Health Information System	IMPLEMENTED	Hosting out to tender 2026-07
Gauteng online school admissions	IMPLEMENTED ↗	2027 intake opened 2026-08-05
IEC digital voter registration (WhatsApp and online portal)	IMPLEMENTED ↗	WhatsApp channel launched 2026-08-04
Minimum Interoperability Standards and GWEA	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Update due 2026-09
MyMzansi single citizen application	PILOTING ↗	Stable platform due 2026-09
National Health Insurance information architecture	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Gazetted as the 2021 HNSF, GN 2667, 2022-10-21
National payment code standard (QR+)	IMPLEMENTED ↗	v1.2, eight-bank cohort, 2026-07
Non-bank payment service provider licensing	PLANNED	NPS Act amendment pending
Online Verification Service	IMPLEMENTED	Fee under review litigation
PayShap	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Standard gazetted 2026-07
SAMOS real-time gross settlement	IMPLEMENTED	Since 1998
Smart ID and bank-branch channel	IMPLEMENTED ↗	372 branches, 2026-08-05
Western Cape Infrastructure Virtual Platform (EVE AI agent)	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Launched at inaugural Infrastructure Ministerial Roundtable, 2026-07-30
Education management information systems	NOT HELD	—
Electronic death registration system	NOT HELD	—

Legislation and regulation

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
National Identification and Registration Bill	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Before Parliament

The Department of Home Affairs' annual performance plan sets the only funded 2026/27 digital identity target as hosting infrastructure, with verifiable credentials [scheduled for 2027/28](#); the department issued [4,002,964 smart identity documents in 2025](#). The enabling regulations are being made under the Identification Act 1998 while the National Identification and Registration Bill remains before Parliament; an analyst [argued in May 2026 that they may be ultra vires](#) on that ground.

The smart identity document bank-branch channel reached [372 participating branches on 2026-08-05](#), from 327 on 2026-07-22, against a departmental target of 750 by end-2026; Home Affairs reported over half a million switches from the green barcoded identity book in under five months, against about 16 million people it says still hold one. It also reported [377,060 identity numbers blocked](#) as at July 2026, down from 702,267, and stated it cannot trace approximately 400,000 of those affected against a court deadline extended to March 2027. On 2026-07-29 the Western Cape High Court [held four categories of exclusion in the birth-registration regulations unconstitutional](#).

The information architecture for National Health Insurance sits inside the [2021 Health Normative Standards Framework](#): a federated model with central patient, provider and facility registries and a national health information exchange. The [National Digital Health Strategy 2019-2024](#) expired at the end of its term with no successor held.

PayShap had recorded 905m transactions by 2026-05, and the Reserve Bank holds [50% of the operating company](#), which it said on 2026-07-31 [will remain bank-owned](#). No go-live date, purpose-limitation, retention or reciprocity term is published for the [customs data exchange signed with the Malawi Revenue Authority on 2026-08-05](#). The student funding scheme is under administration, its administrator reporting in August 2026 that [ICT is its biggest operational risk, "fragmented, manual and not fit for purpose"](#).

Governance and regulation

Other GovTech and e-Gov

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Digital Transformation of Government Roadmap	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Adopted 2025-03-26

Legislation and regulation

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Capital Flow Management Regulations and Crypto Asset Manual	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Manual comments close end-September 2026
Copyright Amendment Bill	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Returned to Parliament 2026-06
Cybercrimes Act	IMPLEMENTED	In force since 2021
End-user and Subscriber Service Charter Amendment Regulations	ENACTED, IN FORCE 2027-01-23 ↗	Under review litigation

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
National Open Science Policy	IMPLEMENTED	No commencement date stated
SADC real-time settlement	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Kwanza added 2026-07-27
AfCFTA Digital Trade Protocol domestication	NOT HELD	—
Cross-border transfer adequacy determinations	NOT HELD	—
Malabo Convention ratification position	NOT HELD	—

Strategies, plans and policies

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Cost to Communicate Roadmap	PLANNED ↗	Market analysis study put out to tender, reported 2026-08-01
Operation Vulindlela Phase II	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Quarterly reporting

Standards

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
ICT and Media Regulators Forum	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Launched 2024

Data protection

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Consumer Protection Act direct-marketing opt-out registry	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Regulations 2026-04
Mandatory breach reporting e-portal	IMPLEMENTED ↗	2025-04
Protection of Personal Information Act and Information Regulator	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Enforceable since 2021

The Information Regulator received 2,374 breach notifications in 2024/25 and [788 in the first quarter of 2026](#), and issued enforcement notices in 2026 against a public college and a mining company. The statutory maximum penalty is R10m, against an IBM-measured average South African breach cost of [R44.1m](#).

A peer-reviewed study found streaming services delivered over the open internet [fall outside licensing, local-content quotas and the Broadcasting Act](#). National Treasury published a draft [Crypto Asset Manual governing cross-border crypto transactions on 2026-08-03](#), for comment to end-September 2026, ahead of its consideration of comments on the Capital Flow Management Regulations it implements. The SADC real-time settlement system [added its second currency](#) in July 2026.

On price, the department put a market analysis study [out to tender](#), reported 2026-08-01, its terms conceding a "current policy vacuum" and that the price benefits expected from the 2022 spectrum auction "remain largely unmet". Its deliverable, a Cost to Communicate Roadmap, is not published.

Artificial intelligence and the technology sector

Legislation and regulation

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Conduct of Financial Institutions Bill	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Before Parliament

Strategies, plans and policies

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
National AI policy	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Cabinet targeted 2026-11

Standards

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
AI-in-finance regulatory framework	PLANNED ↗	Expected 2026
Crypto-asset service provider licensing	IMPLEMENTED ↗	310 licences by 2026-03-31

AI

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Expert review panel	IMPLEMENTED	14 members appointed 2026-05-14
Proposed AI regulatory institutions	PLANNED, UNDER RECONSIDERATION ↗	2026-07
Prudential Authority AI and cloud supervision standards	IN DEVELOPMENT	2026-07
SAHPRA AI/ML medical-device requirements	IMPLEMENTED, REGISTRATION NOT COMMENCED ↗	Issued 2025-09-26
SARS Modernisation 3.0	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Programme announced 2026-04
Sector-level AI strategies	PLANNED	Per redraft approach
AI incident or assurance register	NOT HELD	—
Rules governing state automated decision-making	NOT HELD	—

The minister reported that the electronic travel authorisation had [processed 203,000 applications and rejected more than 5,700](#) by 2026-07-21, with approximately [85% assessed automatically](#); the department publishes no statistical series, and no appeal route, accuracy rate or human-review threshold. The Labour Court [stayed disciplinary proceedings](#) in July 2026 on prima facie evidence that a ruling relied on non-existent authorities.

The draft AI policy was withdrawn in April 2026 after fabricated references were identified, and the department stated on 2026-07-29 that the replacement [will issue guidelines rather than prescribe rules](#), with cabinet targeted for November 2026 and January 2027 as fallback; two timelines are on record and have not been reconciled. The medicines regulator [set binding requirements for AI and machine-learning medical devices in September 2025](#),

requiring prior approval from one of six reference jurisdictions or WHO prequalification for Class C and D devices and evidence that a foreign-trained model performs on local populations, while stating in the same document that it has not commenced product registration of medical devices at all.

In [PwC research](#) among mining executives (n=10, interviews and focus groups), nearly 70% rated AI readiness poor or very poor and more than 85% rated data management average or poor.

Inclusion and capacity

Access to services

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Bank-account means test across eight grants	IMPLEMENTED, UNDER APPEAL ↗	SCA hearing 2026-08-25
MICT SETA	IMPLEMENTED, UNDER GOVERNANCE REVIEW ↗	Referred 2026-07
Postbank Black Card migration	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Deadline 2026-08-31
SASSA biometric verification against Home Affairs	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Compulsory for new applications, 2025-09
Smartphone excise removal	IMPLEMENTED ↗	2025-04
Digital inclusion strategy instrument	NOT HELD	—
Municipal ICT expenditure data	NOT HELD	—
National digital literacy measurement	NOT HELD	—

Training and skills

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
National Competency Framework	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	2026-07
National Digital and Future Skills Strategy 2020	UNDER REVIEW ↗	2026-07

The bank-account means test has been [extended from one grant to eight](#) while the 2025 judgment declaring it unconstitutional is suspended pending appeal, and beneficiaries flagged from September 2025 have [reported continued non-payment](#). Removal of the 9% excise on smartphones under R2,500 was followed by an 80% rise in entry-level volumes and an 87% fall in feature-phone sales [to February 2026](#), figures published by the minister.

Of 463,836 active Postbank gold cards at 2026-04-29, [264,263 were still to be replaced at 2026-07-28](#), against a deadline of 2026-08-31.

Finance

The base holds no finance rows for South Africa. A thin evidence base is a finding, not a gap in this document.

The base holds no dedicated non-state finance rows for South Africa. Across 56 national budget lines drawn from the [Estimates of National Expenditure](#), execution against appropriation for 2024/25 to 2026/27 runs at 86% and 87% for the international and information-society programmes, and at 39% for SA Connect. Home Affairs has tabled [R13.8bn for 2026/27](#).

Gaps to fill

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
Data-centre incentive instrument (SEZ, depreciation, grid priority)	—	not yet probed
Education management information systems	—	not yet probed
Electronic death registration system	—	not yet probed
Cross-border transfer adequacy determinations	—	not yet probed
Malabo Convention ratification position	—	not yet probed
AfCFTA Digital Trade Protocol domestication	—	not yet probed
Rules governing state automated decision-making	—	not yet probed
AI incident or assurance register	—	not yet probed
Digital inclusion strategy instrument	—	not yet probed
National digital literacy measurement	—	not yet probed
Municipal ICT expenditure data	—	not yet probed

The items above marked *Not held* fall into three groups. Firstly, sectoral systems: education management information systems and the electronic death registration system, together with the data-centre incentive instrument signalled in February 2026. Secondly, international instruments: cross-border transfer adequacy determinations under POPIA, the Malabo Convention ratification position and domestication of the AfCFTA Digital Trade Protocol. Thirdly, measurement and the rules governing state automation: a national digital literacy baseline, a digital inclusion strategy instrument, municipal ICT expenditure data, an AI incident or assurance register, and any rule constraining state automated decision-making.

United States and Chinese activity is documented, including Huawei's report of [1,400 local partners and 94.7% of local revenue](#); no European, Gulf or Indian digital instrument for South Africa is held.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

EDITION	2026-08-13
CURRENT EDITION	https://corpus.data-landscapers.com/reports/ZAF/ZAF-status.html
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